COMPANY OPERATING SYSTEM

UI/UX & Digital Product Design Department Handbook

Part 1 · Department charter, employee onboarding plan and 90-day training programme, from beginner to supervised client work

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Tool features, licences and prices change. Verify against the vendor's official page before building or quoting.

How to Use This Handbook

This is Part 1 of 17 in the UI/UX Department operating system. It does three jobs: **(1)** defines what the department is, who does what and how work is approved; **(2)** onboards a new employee with basic computer skills and little design experience; **(3)** gives a day-by-day 90-day programme that takes them to **Junior UI Designer (supervised)**. Parts 2 to 17 teach each subject in full.

GOLDEN RULES OF THE DEPARTMENT

1. Do not skip stages. A stage starts only when the previous approval gate is signed.
2. Design decisions come from user needs and project goals, never from personal taste alone.
3. Never invent research. If an interview or usability test did not happen, no document may say it did.
4. Never promise higher conversion, revenue or "WCAG compliance" without measured evidence.
5. Never copy a competitor's design. Research informs; it does not supply the answer.
6. Every deliverable has a named reviewer who is not its author.
7. Figma is the source of truth for design; the repository stores documents, approved exports and evidence.

Reading path

1 Charter → 2 Roles → 3 Lifecycle & gates → 4 Brand standards → 5 Design samples → 6 Onboarding → 7 90-day plan → 8 Sample lesson → 9 Repo & sources

Contents

1. Department charter and service portfolio
2. Roles, responsibilities and review authority
3. Project lifecycle (16 stages) and approval gates
4. Tool stack and licensing checks
5. VEL design standards: colour palette, type, spacing
6. Design samples (landing, mobile, SaaS, AI, components)
7. Employee onboarding plan (Day 0 to Week 1)
8. 90-day training programme
9. Assessment, competency levels and sign-off
10. Sample lesson in the mandatory 15-point format
11. Repository structure, project IDs, approval log
12. Official learning sources
13. Appendices: glossary, checklists, assessment, answers
14. What comes next (Parts 2 to 17)

HONESTY NOTE ON THIS DOCUMENT

Tool pricing, plan limits and feature names were **not** re-verified from vendor sites while writing this draft, so no subscription prices appear. Contrast ratios in Section 4 are calculated by script from the token file. Anything marked **VERIFY** must be confirmed from the official source before use with a client.

1. Department Charter

Mission

Run a repeatable, quality-controlled Digital Product Design operation that designs websites, mobile apps, SaaS and enterprise products and AI interfaces for international clients, and trains junior employees to deliver that work to a professional standard.

This is a design engineering department, not a freelance graphic studio

Freelance graphic studio	VEL UI/UX department
Starts from "make it look nice"	Starts from a business objective and a defined user
Delivers images or one-off files	Delivers a design system, prototype and developer-ready handoff
Feedback is open-ended	Scope, revision limits and acceptance criteria are written and signed
Quality depends on the individual	Quality is checked by gates, checklists and an independent reviewer
One-time job	Monthly design-support retainer after delivery

Service portfolio (8 divisions)

Division	What we deliver	Typical client trigger
A. Website UI/UX	Business, corporate, e-commerce, portfolio sites; landing pages; responsive layouts; redesigns	"Our site looks old and visitors leave."
B. Mobile App UI/UX	Android, iOS, cross-platform; onboarding, auth, navigation, profile, payment, dashboards	"We need an app that users can learn without help."
C. SaaS Product Design	Dashboards, admin panels, subscriptions, CRM, ERP, HRMS, inventory	"Our product is powerful but hard to use."
D. Enterprise UI/UX	Manufacturing, healthcare, finance, logistics, internal portals	"Staff avoid our internal system."
E. UX Research & Strategy	Interviews, personas, journeys, competitor analysis, information architecture	"We do not know why users drop off."

Division	What we deliver	Typical client trigger
F. UX Audit & Optimisation	Heuristic audits, accessibility reviews, checkout and navigation fixes	"Something is wrong but we cannot say what."
G. Design Systems & Prototyping	Component libraries, tokens, interactive prototypes, documentation, handoff	"Every screen looks different."
H. AI Product UI/UX	Chat and agent interfaces, workflow builders, approval and review screens	"Users do not trust our AI feature."

CLAIMS WE NEVER MAKE

We never promise increased conversion, revenue or retention without measured evidence. We say "WCAG 2.2 level AA target, verified by testing", never "fully accessible" or "compliant" from appearance alone. We never present AI-generated content in an interface as verified fact.

Department principles

User-led

Every decision traces to a user need, a research finding or a project objective, and is written in `design-decisions.md`.

System-first

Tokens and components before screens. A value used twice becomes a token.

Evidence-based

Approvals, test notes and sources are stored. No evidence, no claim.

Accessible by default

Contrast, focus, target size and keyboard order are designed in, not patched later.

Original work

Learn from references; never copy them. Only licensed fonts, images and icons.

Confidential

Client files stay in approved tools. Do not duplicate client assets into the repository unnecessarily.

2. Roles, Responsibilities and Review Authority

A startup may have one person in several roles. That is allowed, but the **author of a deliverable may never be its only approver**: the final-review owner below must be named on every project.

Role	Core responsibilities	Typical outputs	Owns gates
Junior UI Designer	Figma fundamentals, screen creation, component use, responsive layouts, documentation	Screens, component instances, exports, notes	Prepares; approves none
UX Designer	Research, journeys, wireframes, information architecture, usability evaluation	Personas, sitemaps, flows, wireframes, test reports	Prepares G2, G3, G7
Senior Product Designer	Product strategy, design direction, design systems, complex product interfaces, design reviews	Design system, direction board, review notes	Reviews G4, G5, G6, G8
UI/UX Lead	Project architecture, quality standards, client presentation, final design approval	Approved design package, acceptance record	Approves G4 to G9; presents G10
Project Manager	Timeline, client communication, milestones, resources, change management	Plan, status reports, change requests, approval log	Owns G1 and G10 paperwork

Approval ownership by gate

Gate	Evidence required	Prepared by	Internal approver	Client sign-off
G1 Requirements	Design brief, SoW	PM + UX	UI/UX Lead	Yes (written)
G2 Research & flows	Personas, journeys, sitemap, flows	UX Designer	UI/UX Lead	Yes
G3 Wireframes	Wireframe package	UX Designer	Senior Product Designer	Yes

Gate	Evidence required	Prepared by	Internal approver	Client sign-off
G4 Visual direction	Moodboard, palette, type	Senior Product Designer	UI/UX Lead	Yes
G5 Design system	Tokens, components, docs	Product + Junior	Senior Product Designer	Informed
G6 High-fidelity	All screens and states	Junior + Senior	UI/UX Lead	Yes
G7 Prototype & usability	Clickable prototype, test report with real evidence	UX Designer	UI/UX Lead	Review
G8 Design QA	QA checklist passed	Reviewer not on the project	UI/UX Lead	No
G9 Handoff	Specs, tokens, exports, notes	Senior + Junior	UI/UX Lead + a developer	Informed
G10 Acceptance	Client acceptance record	PM	UI/UX Lead	Yes (written)

Career path inside the department

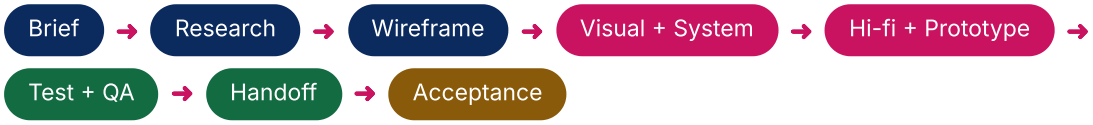
Trainee (Day 1) → Junior UI Designer, supervised (Day 90 target) → Junior, independent on small scope → UX Designer / Product Designer → Senior → Lead

Promotion criteria beyond Day 90 are defined in Part 16 (employee SOPs). Management sets salary bands; this handbook does not.

3. Project Lifecycle and Approval Gates

Every client project follows these 16 stages. Each stage has one deliverable; ten of them end at a gate. Full production design (Stage 09) must not begin until the scope is approved at G1.

Stage	Name	Deliverable	Gate
01	Lead qualification	Lead qualification report	-
02	Client discovery	Client discovery document	-
03	Requirements and scope freeze	Approved requirements + Statement of Work	G1
04	Market and competitor research	Competitor research report and matrix	-
05	UX research and information architecture	Personas, journeys, sitemap, flows	G2
06	Wireframing	Wireframe package (desktop, tablet, mobile)	G3
07	Visual design strategy	Approved design direction	G4
08	Design system development	Design system library	G5
09	High-fidelity UI design	Complete high-fidelity package	G6
10	Interactive prototyping	Clickable prototype, no broken links	-
11	UX testing	Usability testing report (real evidence only)	G7
12	Design QA	QA checklist and approval report	G8
13	Developer handoff	Handoff package	G9
14	Design implementation review	Implementation review report	-
15	Client presentation and approval	Client acceptance record	G10
16	Maintenance and retainer	Monthly deliverables and revision limits	-



RULES FOR GATES

1. An approval is valid only if it is written (email, signed document or tracked comment) and stored in `delivery/` or the portal approval history.
2. "Looks good" in a call is not approval. The PM records it in writing within one working day.
3. Changes after a gate are change requests: written, estimated, approved, then done. Revision limits come from the SoW.
4. Every project has a unique ID, format `VEL-UX-YYYY-NNN` (for example `VEL-UX-2026-001`).

4. Tool Stack and Licensing Checks

Figma is the primary tool and the source of truth. Learn it first; add others only when a project needs them. **Prices are intentionally not listed:** they change. The PM checks the official pricing page and records the date checked in the project cost sheet.

Category	Tool	Use at VEL	Check licence / pricing at VERIFY
Primary UI/UX	**Figma**	Wireframes, UI, components, variables, prototypes, Dev Mode handoff	figma.com/pricing · help.figma.com
Collaboration	FigJam, Miro	Workshops, journey maps, affinity diagrams	figma.com/pricing · miro.com/pricing
Image editing	Photoshop, Photopea	Photo retouching, image export	adobe.com · photopea.com
Vector design	Illustrator, Inkscape	Logos, icons, illustrations (Inkscape is free, open-source)	adobe.com · inkscape.org
Prototyping	Figma, ProtoPie	Click-through and advanced interaction prototypes	protopie.io/pricing
User testing	Maze	Unmoderated tests, task success tracking	maze.co/pricing
Documentation	Notion, Markdown	Briefs, research notes, SOPs, in-repo docs	notion.com/pricing
Version management	GitHub	Docs, exports, tokens, changelog (not the master design file)	github.com/pricing
Accessibility	WebAIM Contrast Checker, browser dev tools	Contrast, focus order, zoom, keyboard checks	webaim.org (free)

LICENSING RULES

1. No cracked or "free-download" software. Every seat is licensed or uses a legitimately free plan.
2. Fonts, icons, photos and illustrations must have a licence that allows commercial client use. Record licence and source in `assets/` notes.
3. VEL's own documents use Inter (SIL Open Font License), Liberation Serif/Times and JetBrains Mono (OFL) which are free for commercial use; confirm the licence text when you download a font.
4. Client files and credentials never go into personal accounts or public AI tools.

Installation and account set-up (all new employees)

1. Create the company Figma account with your VEL email; accept the team invitation; do not use a personal email.
2. Turn on two-factor authentication for Figma, GitHub, Notion and email.
3. Install the Figma desktop app (or use the browser version) and the Inter font; check Figma's current system requirements **VERIFY**.
4. Open the "VEL Training Sandbox" team project. Create a file named `YYYY-MM-DD_Firstname_Day1`.

5. VEL Design Standards

These standards style VEL's own documents, portal and pitch material, and are the practice template for training projects. Client projects use *the client's* brand; use this file to learn how a system is structured. Colours were sampled from the VEL logo and the existing Cloud & DevOps Playbook; the token file is `design-tokens/tokens.json`.

Colour palette

Vel Navy

navy-900
#041E48
Logo wordmark, headings, dark UI

navy-800
#0B2A5E

navy-700
#143A7B
Links, secondary actions

navy-600
#2A5298

navy-100
#E6ECF7
Tints, selected rows

navy-50
#F3F6FB

Lotus Magenta

magenta-800
#8F0D45

magenta-700
#A80F50

magenta-600
#CA1360
Primary action, accent rule

magenta-400
#E8508F

magenta-100
#FCE4EE

magenta-50
#FFF1F6

Temple Gold

gold-700
#8A5A0B
Text on gold tint

gold-600
#B9801A

gold-500
#DDA52B
Highlight on navy only

gold-200
#F6E1AE

gold-100
#FBF0D2

Gem Emerald

emerald-700
#136B42

emerald-600
#1A7F4F
Success, positive status

emerald-500
#26A06A

emerald-100
#DDF3E8

Neutral

neutral-900
#111827

neutral-800
#1F2937

neutral-700
#374151

neutral-600
#4B5563

neutral-500
#6B7280

neutral-300
#D1D5DB

neutral-200
#E5E7EB

neutral-100
#F3F4F6

neutral-50
#F9FAFB

neutral-0
#FFFFFF

Semantic colours (status)

success
#136B42
bg #DDF3E8

warning
#8A5A0B
bg #FBF0D2

error
#B42318
bg #FDE7E4

info
#1D4ED8
bg #E3ECFD

cream-100
#FFF4EA
Callout background

Contrast check (calculated, WCAG 2.2 SC 1.4.3 and 1.4.11)

Ratios are computed from the exact hex values using the WCAG relative-luminance formula. Normal text needs **4.5 : 1**; large text (18pt+, or 14pt bold) and UI component borders/icons need **3 : 1**.

Pair	Sample	Colours	Ratio	Normal text (4.5)	Large text / UI (3)
Body text	Aa	`#111827` on `#FFFFFF`	**17.74 : 1**	**Pass**	**Pass**
Secondary text	Aa	`#4B5563` on `#FFFFFF`	**7.56 : 1**	**Pass**	**Pass**
Muted text (min. allowed)	Aa	`#6B7280` on `#FFFFFF`	**4.83 : 1**	**Pass**	**Pass**
Headings	Aa	`#0B2A5E` on `#FFFFFF`	**13.93 : 1**	**Pass**	**Pass**
Logo navy on white	Aa	`#041E48` on `#FFFFFF`	**16.35 : 1**	**Pass**	**Pass**

Pair	Sample	Colours	Ratio	Normal text (4.5)	Large text / UI (3)
Link / secondary action	Aa	`#143A7B` on `#FFFFFF`	10.93 : 1	Pass	Pass
Primary button label	Aa	`#FFFFFF` on `#CA1360`	5.57 : 1	Pass	Pass
Magenta text on white	Aa	`#CA1360` on `#FFFFFF`	5.57 : 1	Pass	Pass
Magenta text on cream	Aa	`#CA1360` on `#FFF4EA`	5.14 : 1	Pass	Pass
Magenta on its own tint	Aa	`#CA1360` on `#FCE4EE`	4.63 : 1	Pass	Pass
Navy on gold-500 highlight	Aa	`#041E48` on `#DDA52B`	7.39 : 1	Pass	Pass
Gold-600 on white (DO NOT use for text)	Aa	`#B9801A` on `#FFFFFF`	3.41 : 1	Fail	Pass
Gold-700 on white	Aa	`#8A5A0B` on `#FFFFFF`	5.92 : 1	Pass	Pass
Gold-700 on gold-100 (warning)	Aa	`#8A5A0B` on `#FBF0D2`	5.21 : 1	Pass	Pass
Emerald-600 on white	Aa	`#1A7F4F` on `#FFFFFF`	5.01 : 1	Pass	Pass
Success on success-bg	Aa	`#136B42` on `#DDF3E8`	5.63 : 1	Pass	Pass
Error on white	Aa	`#B42318` on `#FFFFFF`	6.57 : 1	Pass	Pass
Info on white	Aa	`#1D4ED8` on `#FFFFFF`	6.70 : 1	Pass	Pass
Magenta-400 on white (DO NOT use)	Aa	`#E8508F` on `#FFFFFF`	3.51 : 1	Fail	Pass
Emerald-500 on white (DO NOT use)	Aa	`#26A06A` on `#FFFFFF`	3.32 : 1	Fail	Pass

COLOUR RULES THAT FOLLOW FROM THE NUMBERS

- Gold-600, magenta-400 and emerald-500 **fail** for text on white. Use them for decoration or large graphics only, or switch to the 700 shade.
- Gold-500 is a highlight on navy backgrounds only (navy text on it passes).
- Never convey meaning by colour alone: status always carries an icon or a text label as well.
- Primary action is always Lotus Magenta-600 with a white label. One primary button per view.

Typography

Display · 44px	**Design with purpose**
H1 · 32px serif bold	**Project overview**
H2 · 24px serif bold	**Research findings**
H3 · 18px Inter 600	**User journey stage**
Body · 16px / 1.5	Body text is Inter regular with a 1.5 line-height for readable paragraphs.
Small · 14px	Helper text, table cells and captions.
Caption · 12px (min.)	Never smaller than 12px on screen.
Mono · code	`--color-primary: #CA1360;`

Spacing, radius, shadow, grid

Spacing scale (4px base)

space-0 = 0px
space-1 = 4px
space-2 = 8px
space-3 = 12px
space-4 = 16px
space-5 = 24px
space-6 = 32px
space-7 = 48px
space-8 = 64px
space-9 = 96px

Radius

sm 4 · md 8 · lg 12 · pill 999 px

Shadow

sm `0 1px 2px` · md `0 4px 12px` · lg `0 12px 32px` (navy at 8-14 % opacity)

Grid

Desktop 12 columns, 24px gutter, 1280px max · Tablet 8 columns, 16px gutter · Mobile 4 columns, 16px margin

Breakpoints

360 · 768 · 1280 px

Touch targets
WCAG 2.2 minimum 24×24 CSS px (SC 2.5.8); VEL standard 44×44 px.

Starter token file (excerpt)

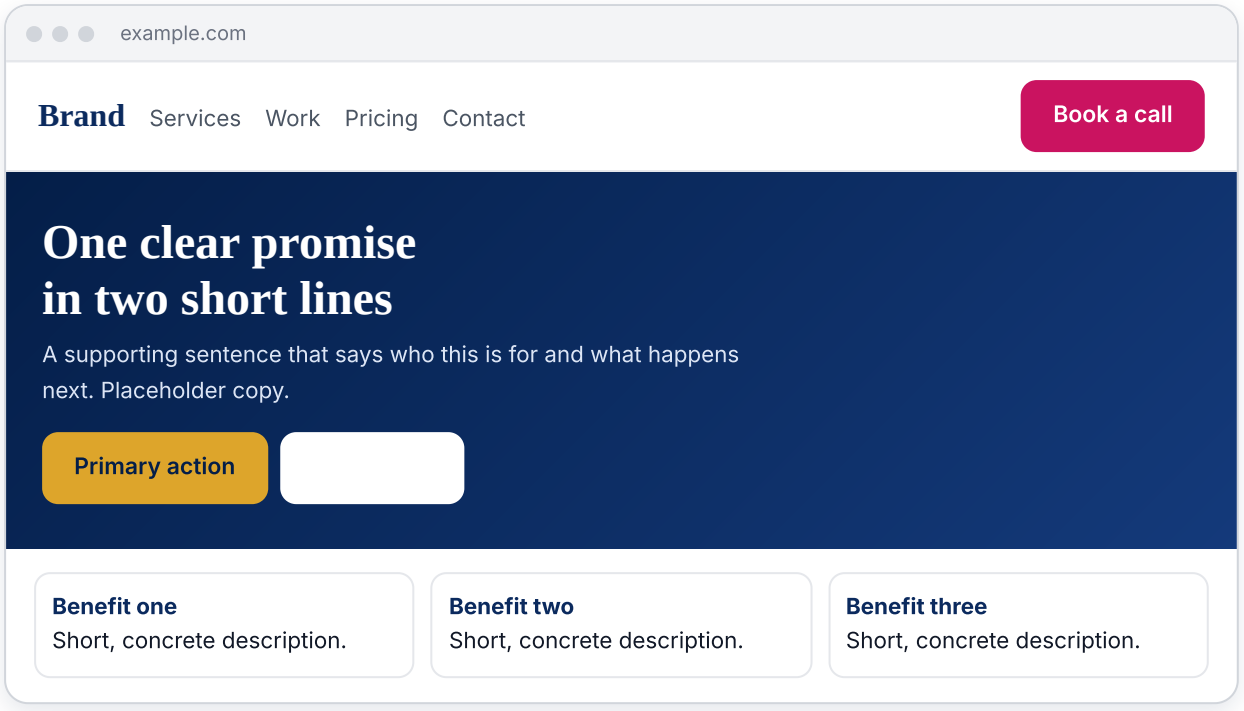
```
{
 "color": {
  "navy": {
   "900": "#041E48",
   "800": "#0B2A5E",
   "700": "#143A7B",
   "600": "#2A5298",
   "100": "#E6ECF7",
   "50": "#F3F6FB"
  },
  "magenta": {
   "800": "#8F0D45",
   "700": "#A80F50",
   "600": "#CA1360",
   "400": "#E8508F",
   "100": "#FCE4EE",
   "50": "#FFF1F6"
  }
 },
 "font": "Inter,'Segoe UI',Roboto,'Helvetica Neue',Arial,sans-serif",
 "spacing-px": [
  0,
  4,
  8,
  12,
  16,
  24,
  32,
  48,
  64,
  96
 ]
}
```

Full file: `design-tokens/tokens.json`. In Figma, create these as Variables (collections: Primitives, Semantic) so Dev Mode shows names, not hex codes.

6. Design Samples

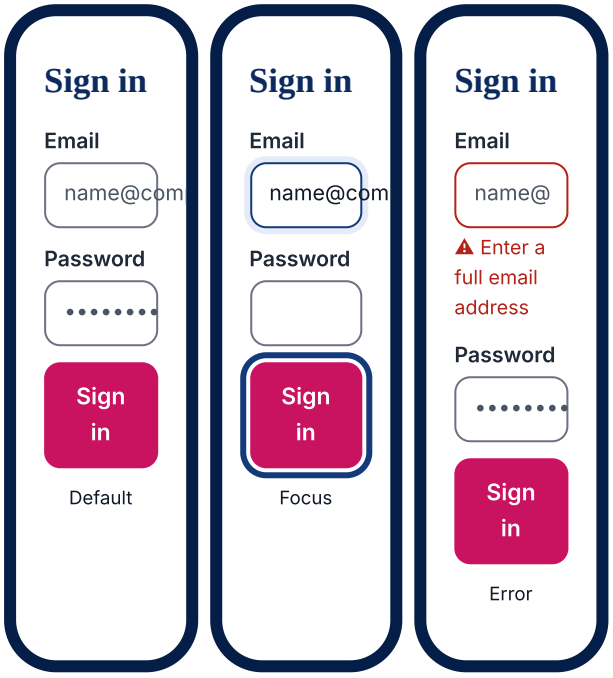
Five reference samples built with the VEL tokens. They are **teaching examples with dummy content**, not client work and not evidence of results. The employee's first task is to rebuild each one in Figma (Auto Layout, components, variables) and explain every design choice.

Sample A · Landing page (desktop)

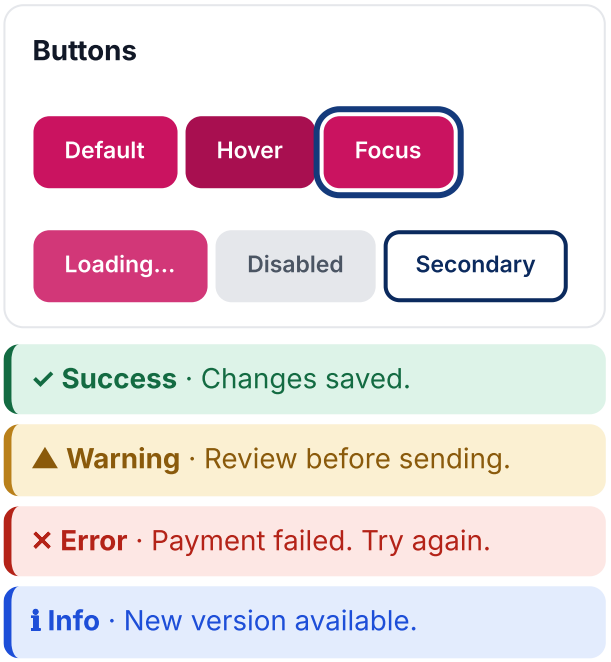


Why it works: one primary action (magenta/gold on navy), headline larger than everything else, three equal cards on a consistent 8px rhythm, 12-column alignment.

Sample B · Mobile login (3 states)



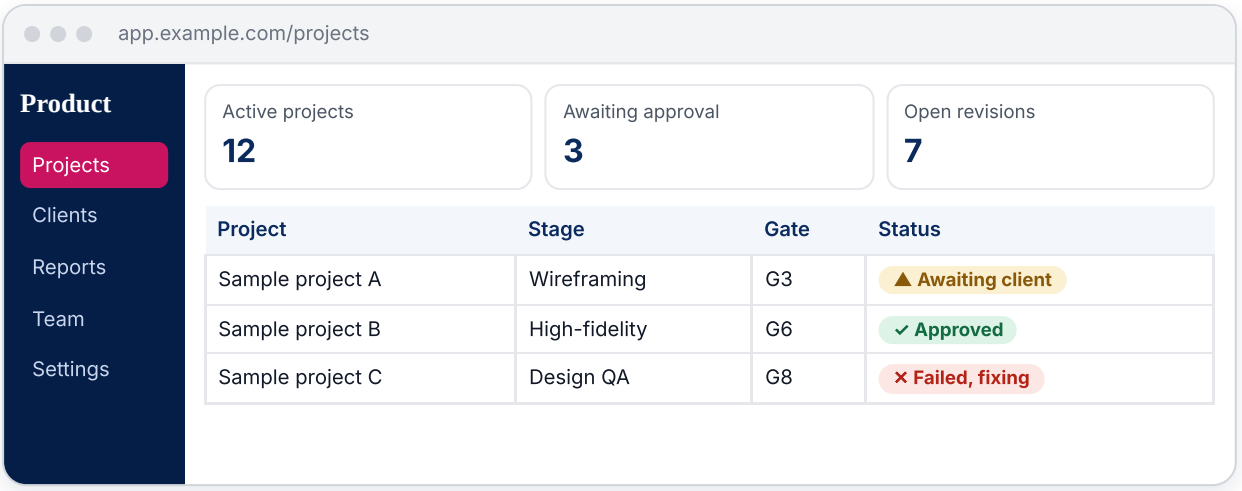
Sample C · Component states



Visible labels (not placeholders), error shown with icon + text, focus ring in navy.

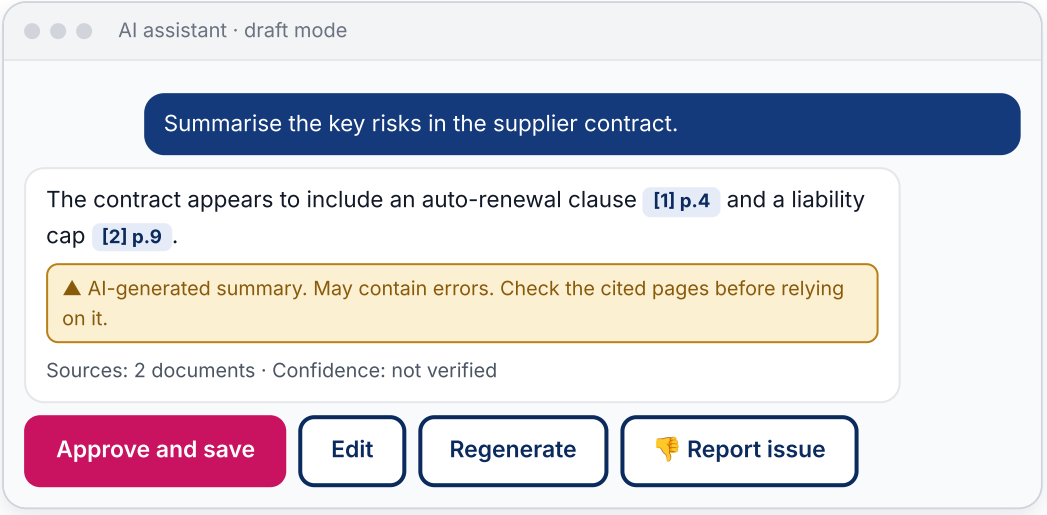
Every state is designed before handoff: default, hover, focus, active, disabled, loading, error, empty, success.

Sample D · SaaS dashboard (dummy data)



Dark navy navigation with one highlighted item, KPI cards, a table with text + icon status tags. Real tables also need sort, filter, search, pagination, bulk actions, role-aware menus, and empty/loading/error states (Part 7).

Sample E · AI assistant with sources and human approval



AI rules shown: citations link to the source, uncertainty is stated in words, a human approval step exists before anything is saved or sent, regenerate and feedback are visible. Never show AI output as verified fact.

7. Employee Onboarding Plan

Entry profile: basic computer knowledge, limited or no design experience. **Exit target (Day 90):** Junior UI Designer who can build clean, accessible, responsive screens in Figma from an approved wireframe and brief, document their decisions, and join a client project under supervision.

Before Day 1 (management and PM)

Item	Owner	Done
Offer, employment terms, confidentiality / NDA and IP-assignment signed	Management	☐
Company email, Figma seat in the training team, Notion workspace, GitHub org invite	PM	☐
Laptop and a reliable external mouse and a second display if available; browser and Figma desktop app installed	PM	☐
Mentor (a UX Designer or above) and a peer buddy assigned	UI/UX Lead	☐
Training Sandbox project, this handbook and a weekly calendar shared	PM	☐

Day 1 schedule

Time	Activity	Output
Hour 1	Welcome, company overview, department charter (Section 1), who is who	Signed acknowledgement
Hour 2	Confidentiality, security basics: 2FA, password manager, no client data on personal accounts	2FA enabled on all accounts
Hour 3-4	Account and tool set-up (Section 4), file naming, sandbox tour	`Day1` Figma file created
Hour 5-6	First lesson: "What is UI and what is UX?" followed by 20-minute exercise	5 photos or screenshots of good and bad everyday interfaces with one sentence each
Hour 7	Mentor 1:1: expectations, the 90-day plan, how reviews work	Written goals for Week 1
Hour 8	Learning log (first entry) and end-of-day recap	Notion learning log started

Week 1 rhythm (repeats every week)

Day	Focus	Ritual
Mon	New topic taught (30 % of time)	10-min stand-up: yesterday, today, blockers
Tue-Thu	Practice and exercises (50 %)	Daily learning log: 3 lines on what you learned and what confused you
Fri	Review, documentation, demo (20 %)	30-min design review with mentor; weekly checklist signed

WORKING STANDARDS FROM DAY 1

1. File names: `YYYY-MM-DD_Project_Screen_v01`. Pages named by purpose: `Cover`, `Research`, `Wireframes`, `UI`, `Components`, `Archive`.
2. Layer names always meaningful. "Rectangle 214" is a defect.
3. Ask for help after 30 minutes stuck. Not asking is the bigger risk.
4. Never publish or share a Figma link with "anyone can edit".

Support and escalation

Technical or tool problem: buddy, then mentor. Unclear requirement: mentor, then PM. Quality dispute: UI/UX Lead decides. Concern about conduct or safety: management, in confidence.

8. 90-Day Training Programme

13 weeks in three phases. Every week ends with a deliverable reviewed by a named reviewer. The programme covers Levels 1 to 4 fully, and introduces Levels 5 to 9 at awareness-plus-practice depth; full mastery of those and Projects 6 to 10 continues in Days 91 to 180 (Part 17).

Phase 1 · Foundations · Days 1-30 → Phase 2 · Users and Systems · Days 31-60 →
Phase 3 · Products and Practice · Days 61-90

Phase 1 · Foundations (Weeks 1 to 4)

Week / working days	Learn	Practise in Figma	Deliverable
1 **Days 1-5**	Onboarding. UI vs UX, human-computer interaction, visual hierarchy, alignment. Figma interface, frames, shapes, text	Copy a simple app screen exactly (study, not for sale); then redraw it with your own hierarchy	Screen study + learning log. **Reviewer:** mentor
2 **Days 6-10**	Contrast, typography (families, weights, line height, letter spacing), colour theory, spacing	Type scale sheet; build a palette from a logo; check every pair with a contrast checker	Type + colour sheet with calculated ratios
3 **Days 11-15**	Layout grids, consistency, composition, responsive design, accessibility basics (WCAG 2.2 AA targets)	Auto Layout, constraints, components, variants; 12-col / 8-col / 4-col grids	Responsive card and navbar component set
4 **Days 16-20**	**Project 1:** brief, hero, sections, call to action, copy hierarchy	Business landing page, desktop and mobile frames	Landing page + design notes. **Reviewer:** Senior Product Designer

CHECKPOINT A **DAY 30 REVIEW (30 MIN WITH MENTOR AND LEAD)**

Pass criteria: 2 of 2 fundamentals quizzes ≥ 70 %; Project 1 meets the Section 4 contrast rules; files and layers follow naming standards; learning log complete. Outcome: proceed, or a written 1-week support plan.

Phase 2 · Users and Systems (Weeks 5 to 8)

Week / working days	Learn	Practise	Deliverable
5 **Days 21-25**	User research, interviews, personas, pain points, journeys, user flows, information architecture. **Never invent findings.**	Interview 3 real people about a task (for example paying a bill); write notes and an affinity map	Interview notes, persona based *only* on notes, journey map
6 **Days 26-30**	Sitemap, task flows, low-fi wireframes; heuristic evaluation (Nielsen's 10)	Wireframe 5 screens in greyscale; FigJam flow	Wireframe package for G3 practice
7 **Days 31-35**	Components: buttons, inputs, cards, tables, modals, navigation; every interaction state; Variables and tokens	Build a 15-component mini library with states	Component page + token collection
8 **Days 36-40**	**Project 2:** five-page corporate site (Home, About, Services, Pricing, Contact), desktop / tablet / mobile	High-fidelity pages using the library	5-page responsive design. **Reviewer:** Lead

CHECKPOINT B **DAY 60 REVIEW**

Pass criteria: research documents contain only evidence actually collected; Project 2 reuses components with no detached or off-token values; interaction states exist for all inputs and buttons; knowledge quiz 2 ≥ 70 %.

Phase 3 · Products and Professional Practice (Weeks 9 to 13)

Week / working days	Learn	Practise	Deliverable
9 **Days 41-45**	Mobile: Android and iOS conventions (Material, HIG), navigation, onboarding, auth, forms, errors, empty states	**Project 3:** mobile onboarding + login + registration + home	Mobile flow prototype
10 **Days 46-50**	SaaS: tables, filters, search, sorting, pagination, bulk actions, roles, charts	**Project 4:** SaaS admin dashboard	Dashboard with 3 role views and all data states
11 **Days 51-55**	Design systems: naming, documentation, governance. Intro to AI interface patterns	**Project 5:** reusable design system (tokens + 25 components)	System file + usage docs. **Reviewer:** Senior

Week / working days	Learn	Practise	Deliverable
12 **Days 56-60**	Prototyping, usability testing, UX audit method, accessibility testing, Design QA, developer handoff	Mini-audit of a public site (Project 7 starter); test your prototype with 3 users; run QA checklist	Audit report, test notes, QA report, handoff pack
13 **Days 61-65**	Revision, presentation skills, client communication basics	Shadow a live or simulated client stage; present your best project	Portfolio case study + final assessment

Day numbers above count training working days; with weekends and public holidays the programme spans roughly 90 calendar days. The PM adjusts the calendar and records it.

CHECKPOINT C **DAY 90 FINAL COMPETENCY REVIEW**

Panel: UI/UX Lead, Senior Product Designer, PM. Evidence: portfolio of Projects 1 to 5, audit starter, learning log, quiz scores, mentor report. Outcome: **Certified Junior (supervised)**, **Extend 30 days** with a written plan, or **Not certified**.

Mapping to the 10 mandatory training projects

#	Project	When
1	Professional business landing page	Week 4
2	Responsive five-page corporate website	Week 8
3	Mobile app with onboarding and authentication	Week 9
4	SaaS admin dashboard	Week 10
5	Reusable design system	Week 11
6	Interactive enterprise application prototype	Days 91-120
7	UX audit of an existing product	Starter in Week 12; full in Days 91-120
8	Redesign from documented usability issues	Days 91-150
9	AI chatbot and AI agent dashboard interface	Days 121-150
10	Full simulated international client project	Days 151-180

9. Assessment, Competency Levels and Sign-off

Weights and pass marks below are a **proposal for management approval**.

Component	Weight	How measured	Assessor
Practical projects 1 to 5	50 %	Rubric below, scored out of 100 per project	Senior / Lead
Knowledge assessments (5 quizzes)	20 %	Closed-book, 20 questions each	Mentor
Professional practice	15 %	Naming, file hygiene, documentation, learning log, punctuality of deliveries	Mentor
Communication and review response	15 %	Quality of design explanations, handling feedback, asking for help	Lead + buddy

Pass rule: overall ≥ 70 % **and** each component ≥ 60 % **and** no breach of the golden rules (for example, invented research is an automatic fail of that deliverable).

Project scoring rubric (100 points)

Criterion	Pts	What a full score looks like
Brief fit and user focus	15	Solves the stated objective; every key decision has a written reason
Visual hierarchy and layout	20	Clear focal point; consistent grid and spacing from the scale
Typography and colour	15	Defined type scale; palette from tokens; all text pairs meet 4.5:1 (or 3:1 large)
Components and consistency	15	Reusable components, variants, no detached styles or magic numbers
States and responsiveness	15	Hover, focus, disabled, loading, error, empty, success; desktop, tablet, mobile
Accessibility checks	10	Focus visible, targets ≥ 24px (44px preferred), colour not sole signal, alt text notes
Documentation and file hygiene	10	Named layers/pages, design-decisions note, export-ready, correct file names

Competency levels (what each means)

Level	Description	Allowed to
0 Aware	Knows the term and purpose	Observe
1 Guided	Does the task with step-by-step help	Practise in sandbox
2 Supervised	Does the task correctly; reviewer checks every output	Work on client deliverables with review
3 Independent	Does the task correctly and explains choices; spot-checked	Own a small scope
4 Leads	Teaches others and sets standards	Review others' work

Day-90 target: Level 2 in Levels 1 and 4 skills (fundamentals, components, Figma), Level 1 in research, SaaS, mobile and AI design, Level 0-1 in costing and sales.

Module sign-off sheet (copy for each module)

Field	Entry
Employee / module / dates	
Deliverable link (Figma and document)	
Checklist complete (Y/N)	
Quiz score	
Reviewer name, score, comments	
Result: Approved / Revise (list items)	
Reviewer signature and date · Employee signature and date	

10. Sample Lesson: Visual Hierarchy

This is the template for every lesson in Parts 2 to 17: the mandatory 15-point format. Week 1 begins here.

✕ Poor hierarchy

Our services
We design websites and apps. Call us today for a quote.
Learn more · Contact · Pricing · About us

Everything is the same size and weight: the eye has nowhere to start.

✓ Good hierarchy

Design that users understand

Websites and apps for growing businesses.

Get a free audit See our work

Size, weight, colour and space say: headline, support, action, extra.

1. What is it?	The order in which the eye notices things on a screen, created by size, weight, colour, contrast, position and space.
2. Why does it matter?	Users scan, they do not read. Hierarchy tells them what is most important and what to do next.
3. Where is it used?	Every screen: websites, apps, dashboards, forms, documents, slide decks.
4. Business problem solved	Users miss the main action or message, so tasks take longer or are abandoned. (We measure this in testing; we do not promise a percentage.)
5. Tools needed	Figma (text styles, Auto Layout), a contrast checker.
6. Install and configure	Section 4 set-up. Add Inter font; create text styles H1, H2, Body, Caption.
7. Steps	1. Write the one thing the user must notice first. 2. Make it the largest or heaviest element. 3. Choose second and third levels; give each a distinct size/weight. 4. Group related items with space (use the 8px scale). 5. Give the primary action the only magenta fill. 6. Squint test: blur the screen; the order must still read.
8. Expected output	A frame with exactly 3 text levels, 1 primary action, consistent spacing, saved as styles.
9. Verify	Squint test with a colleague (can they say the main message in 5 seconds?); check contrast ratios; compare against checklist.

10. Common mistakes	Too many bold items; five font sizes; colour used for decoration; centred long paragraphs; two competing primary buttons.
11. Professional standards	Max 3-4 text sizes per screen; body ≥ 16px on mobile; line length 45-75 characters; one primary action per view.
12. Documentation	A note in `design-decisions.md` : "Headline is level 1 because ...".
13. Practical assignment	Redesign the "poor" card above for a real local business of your choice. Deliver before/after frames.
14. Evaluation	Rubric (Section 9): hierarchy 20, typography/colour 15, documentation 10 etc.
15. Approver	Mentor (Week 1); Senior Product Designer for Project 1.

MODULE WRAP-UP (APPEARS AT THE END OF EVERY MODULE)

Summary: hierarchy = size + weight + colour + space, ordered by importance. **Assignment:** item 13. **Checklist:** 3 levels · 1 primary action · styles saved · contrast checked · decision noted. **Assessment:** quiz questions 1-3 in Appendix C. **Deliverable:** before/after Figma frames + note. **Approval criteria:** squint test passed, no rubric item below 60 %.

11. Repository Structure and Approval Records

Figma holds the master design. The repository holds documents, approved exports, evidence and tokens. Use this structure for every project (project ID in the repo name, for example `vel-ux-2026-001-clientname`). Do not copy confidential client assets into the repository unless the contract allows it.

```
ui-ux-project/
├── README.md  CHANGELOG.md
├── docs/            project-overview, design-brief, requirements, competitor-research,
│                    user-personas, user-journey, sitemap, design-decisions,
│                    accessibility, handoff, qa-report (.md)
├── research/        references/ competitor-analysis/ user-interviews/ usability-tests/
findings/
├── design-system/   foundations/ (colours, typography, spacing, grid .md)
│                    components/ patterns/ design-tokens/
├── wireframes/      desktop/ tablet/ mobile/
├── ui-design/       desktop/ tablet/ mobile/ light-theme/ dark-theme/
├── prototypes/
├── assets/          images/ icons/ illustrations/ exports/
├── testing/         usability/ accessibility/ visual-qa/
├── handoff/         specifications/ assets/ developer-notes/
└── delivery/        final-approval.md  delivery-checklist.md
```

Git conventions

- Branches: `main` (approved only), `draft/<topic>` for work in progress. Never commit passwords, API keys or client personal data.
- Commit messages: `G3: add mobile wireframes v02` (gate or stage, then what).
- Update `CHANGELOG.md` with every approved version; tag releases `v1.0-G6`.

Approval log template (`delivery/approval-log.md`)

Gate	Version / link	Submitted	Approved by (name, role)	Evidence (file or email)	Date
G1	Brief v03				
G2					

Design decision record (`docs/design-decisions.md`)

```
## DD-014 · Primary button colour
Decision: Magenta-600 (#CA1360) with white label.
Reason: 5.57:1 contrast on white (calculated); brand accent; user test noted it was found
first.
Alternatives rejected: Gold-600 (3.41:1, fails for text). Decided by: Lead. Date: YYYY-
MM-DD.
```

12. Official Learning Sources

Use primary sources. Before quoting any source to a client, open it and record the access date; pages move and standards update.

Topic	Source	Use it for
Figma	help.figma.com · figma.com/resource-library/	Official tutorials, Auto Layout, variables, Dev Mode
UX research and heuristics	nngroup.com/articles/ (e.g. 10 Usability Heuristics; How Many Test Users)	Research method, usability principles
Accessibility guidance	w3.org/WAI/	Plain-language WCAG help, tutorials
Accessibility standard	w3.org/TR/WCAG22/ · w3.org/WAI/WCAG22/Understanding/	Exact success criteria (1.4.3, 1.4.11, 2.4.7, 2.5.8)
Android design	m3.material.io	Material 3 components and layout
iOS design	developer.apple.com/design/human-interface-guidelines/	Apple Human Interface Guidelines
Design practice	design.google	Case studies, principles
Web performance and UX	web.dev	Responsive design, Core Web Vitals
Usability testing	maze.co/resources/	Test planning guides
Contrast checking	webaim.org/resources/contrastchecker/	Manual verification of ratios
Laws of UX	lawsofux.com	Quick reference of cognitive principles (secondary source)

Key WCAG 2.2 criteria used in this handbook

SC	Requirement (summary)	Level
1.4.3 Contrast (Minimum)	Text ≥ 4.5:1; large text ≥ 3:1	AA
1.4.11 Non-text Contrast	UI components and graphics ≥ 3:1	AA
1.4.1 Use of Color	Colour is not the only visual means of conveying information	A

SC	Requirement (summary)	Level
2.4.7 Focus Visible	Keyboard focus indicator is visible	AA
2.5.8 Target Size (Minimum)	Pointer targets at least 24×24 CSS px (with exceptions)	AA

Summaries are paraphrases for training. The normative text at w3.org/TR/WCAG22 governs. These links were not opened while this draft was written: **VERIFY** on first use.

Appendices

A. Glossary (plain language)

Term	Meaning
UI	User interface: what the user sees and touches (colours, text, buttons, layout)
UX	User experience: how easy, clear and satisfying it is to get something done
HCI	Human-computer interaction: the study of how people use computers
Visual hierarchy	The order in which the eye notices things
Wireframe	A simple, greyscale layout showing structure, not style
Prototype	A clickable model that behaves like the product
Persona	A fictional-but-evidence-based profile that summarises a real user group
User journey	The steps and feelings a user goes through to reach a goal
Information architecture	How content is organised and labelled
Component	A reusable interface piece (button, card, input)
Variant	A version of a component (hover, disabled, large)
Auto Layout	Figma feature that resizes and spaces content automatically
Design token / Variable	A named value (colour, spacing) used everywhere instead of a raw number
Design system	Tokens + components + rules + documentation
WCAG	Web Content Accessibility Guidelines; levels A, AA, AAA
Contrast ratio	Measure of difference between text and background brightness
Handoff	Giving developers everything needed to build the design
SoW	Statement of Work: the signed scope, deliverables, exclusions and limits
Gate (G1-G10)	A mandatory approval before the next stage may start

B. Weekly self-check (employee, every Friday)

☐ Weekly deliverable exported and linked in the portal / Notion

☐ Layers, pages and files named to standard
☐ All text pairs checked for contrast
☐ A decision note written for every non-obvious choice
☐ Learning log has 5 entries
☐ I asked at least one question I was unsure about
☐ Nothing in my work was copied from a competitor or an unlicensed source

C. Knowledge assessment 1 (Week 1) with answer key

#	Question	Answer
1	Give one difference between UI and UX.	UI is what is seen and touched; UX is the overall ease and outcome of using it.
2	Name four tools that create visual hierarchy.	Size, weight, colour, contrast, position, space (any four).
3	What is the squint test?	Blur or squint at a screen; the most important elements should still stand out in the right order.
4	Minimum contrast for normal text under WCAG AA?	4.5 : 1.
5	Does `#B9801A` text on white pass AA? Why?	No. Calculated ratio is 3.41 : 1, below 4.5 : 1.
6	Why not use colour alone to show an error?	Some users cannot distinguish the colour; add an icon and text (WCAG 1.4.1).
7	Who approves your Week-1 deliverable?	Your mentor.
8	You only interviewed 1 person. Can the persona say "most users prefer X"?	No. Never state findings you did not collect; record it as a single observation.
9	Where is the master design file kept?	In Figma, not in the repository.
10	What must you do before sharing a Figma link with a client?	Check permissions (view or comment only), confirm the file is client-ready and approved by the reviewer.

What Comes Next

This completes **Part 1**. Parts 2 to 17 follow the same format (15-point lesson, summary, assignment, checklist, assessment, deliverable, approval criteria).

Part	Topic
2	Beginner design fundamentals (Level 1 in full)
3	Figma from zero to professional
4	UX research and competitor analysis
5	Website design engineering
6	Mobile application design
7	SaaS and enterprise dashboard design
8	Design systems and component libraries
9	AI product experience design
10	Prototyping and usability testing
11	Accessibility and design QA
12	Professional folder structures and GitHub documentation
13	Developer handoff and implementation review
14	Commercial costing and pricing (uses vendor-verified prices only)
15	International client acquisition and sales
16	Project management and employee SOPs
17	Practical training and final competency assessment

OPEN DECISIONS FOR MANAGEMENT

1. Approve assessment weights and pass marks (Section 9).
2. Confirm Figma seat type for trainees and client-shared files **VERIFY**.
3. Confirm working hours and public-holiday calendar so the 13-week plan can be dated.
4. Name the mentor, Senior reviewer and UI/UX Lead for the first trainee.